

Direct3D settings

The Direct3D settings menu is similar to that of the OpenGL settings. In the main settings, enable the Custom Settings option. Under Custom Settings, reduce Anti-Aliasing and Anisotropic Filtering to the least possible values, and



Use the Direct3D settings menu to fine tune your ATI graphics card

enable Performance instead of Quality. Adjust the Texture Preference and MipMap Detail levels to High Performance, and turn off Vertical Sync.

Advanced ATI Tweaks

To access some of the hidden features of the ATI Radeon cards, use PowerStrip. It will let you comprehensively tweak all standard and hidden features of your Radeon card.

Performance counts

PowerStrip resides in the System Tray. To access all the features, right-click on the icon, and choose from the

available options. The performance options are located by going to **Performance profiles > Configure**. From here, you can tweak the performance features of the Radeon without entering the Catalyst driver applet. Using PowerStrip, you can also tweak other settings, such as the ideal Colour and Display profiles.

Overclocking and pushing it

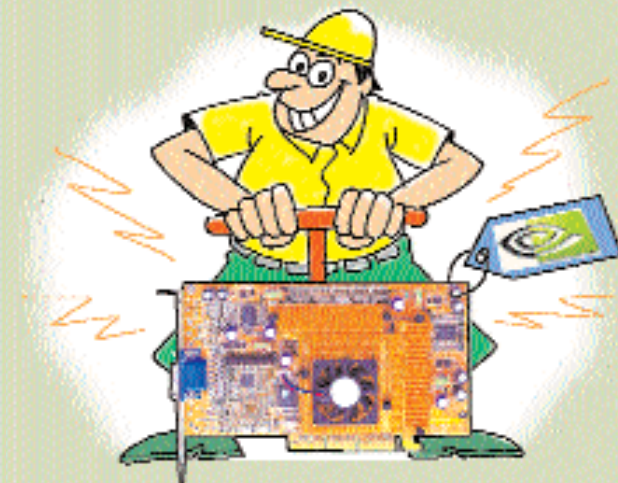
To obtain the best out of your card, you can overclock your GPU and graphics memory speed; but remember, doing so will void your warranty. Moreover, you may damage your card irreparably.

You can overclock your Radeon using PowerStrip; the standard ATI Catalyst driver interface will not let you tweak the GPU and memory speeds. This can be done by moving the sliders within the Clock controls section of the Performance profiles applet. If they appear to have been disabled, check and see if the 'Disable clock controls' option has been selected, and if so, deselect it. Overclocking will lead to a performance boost, but do it cautiously, in 5 MHz increments. Move both the Engine Clock and the Memory Clock speeds up by 5 MHz, and test the system to ensure that it's stable. Once you feel that you've got that additional punch in performance, leave the sliders in position.

Remember, too big an increment will damage your card irreparably. You can choose to save the setting as a performance profile for future

use. Watch out for excessive temperature increases; ensure that your cooling unit is working properly before attempting this.

nVidia TWEAKING



Performance

Under the Performance and Quality Settings option in the fold out menu, you can tweak the card for best performance. First, move the Image Settings slider to High Performance. After that, move the Anti-Aliasing slider to the left, to 'Anti-Aliasing - Off'. Similarly turn the Anisotropic Filtering to the Off position. After this, deselect the Texture Sharpening option.

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Under the Performance and Quality Settings option, you can set the Performance and Compatibility options for the Direct3D API-based applications. Select 'Best Performance for Mipmap Detail Level', and leave the PCI Tex-

ture Memory Size at its default level. You may need to enable Fog table emulation if you see a plain white screen while playing a game.

OpenGL settings

This is located next to the Direct3D setting; set the 'Default Color Depth' to 16 bpp for good performance; remember that setting it to 32 bpp will result in a performance hit. Turn off Vertical Sync and disable Anisotropic Filtering.

Unlocking hidden features

To unlock the more subtle features within the Detonator drivers, use tools such as nVHardPage (<http://www.nvhardpage.com>). Run the utility. To get the hidden options,

85